

Town of Westhampton
Town Hall
1 South Road
Westhampton, MA 01027

Finance Committee Meeting Minutes
Tuesday, January 13, 2015

The meeting convened at 7:00 PM

Present:

Finance Committee Members: Ellice Gonzalez, Jackie Brodeur, Mary Cleary, Tom Cleary, Jr., Maryanne Duggan, Aniko Giordano, Margaret Parsons, Joseph Pipczynski, Celeste Whiting. Also present: Phil Dowling, Art Pichette and Cheryl Provost.

1. Vote to accept minutes of FinCom meeting of 11/11/14. Vote 8-0-0.
2. Correspondence: Beacon arrived. All received CD of the updated 2014 Finance Committee Handbook.
3. Old Business:

Westhampton has a new accountant, Joe Boudreau. We are pleased.

The FY16 budget request and budget forms went out to all Westhampton departments. There was correspondence from Superintendent Craig Jurgensen requesting the budget letter and forms. Cheryl sent them to him.

Meeting Dates: HRSD Finance Subcommittee will meet on Tuesday, Jan. 27th at 5:30

HRSD will hold their preliminary budget hearing on Monday, Feb. 2 at 6:30 at Hampshire Regional.

There is a Westhampton Special Town Meeting on Monday, Feb. 2 at 7:30 at Town Hall.

4. The Franklin Regional Council of Governments held a workshop called Promising Ideas for Achieving Transparency and Cooperation in School Budgeting on December 11, 2014. Mary attended and reported on the workshop to FinCom. See attached notes.

5. Selectboard members Art Pichette and Phil Dowling reported on the history and status of the IT plans and article. They withdrew the article submitted to FinCom for recommendation for Special Town Meeting in light of new information received last week on an alternate solution to the computer-sharing needs of the Town Accountant and the Treasurer. They are looking toward a more comprehensive IT article for the Annual Town Meeting.

6. FinCom approved a request to transfer \$2.00 from the Reserve Fund to the Conservation Commission Expense account. Vote 9-0-0.

7. HRSD budget meeting: Ellice and Aniko attended the HRSD Finance subcommittee meeting on January 5. At the meeting the HR principal presented a list of items for consideration in the upcoming budget. The list was divided into urgent needs and important, but not urgent items.

8. Future FinCom Meetings: The department budgets are due on Feb. 17. Ellice will email them to the FinCom members for review. We will begin the budget review and department meetings on Tuesday, March 3 at 7:00. We will hold meetings on all Tuesdays in March (3rd, 10th, 17th, 24th, and 31st). The first three meetings will be for presentations from town departments. The last two meetings are for deliberations and final budget approval. We must submit a final budget by the first Monday.

9. Joe reported on the announcement by Gov. Charlie Baker that road funding will increase by 100 million dollars for the state. Westhampton will receive approximately an additional \$100,000 in Chapter 90 money this year which will improve our roads. (approximately \$180,000 increased to \$283,371).

We may meet briefly after the Special Town Meeting on Monday, February 2 if there is a need to make any transfers for the IT cable, etc.

The meeting adjourned at 8:25 pm.

Respectfully Submitted by Mary Cleary